

Boix 2003 RG Notes

Boix, Carles. *Democracy and Redistribution*.
New York: Cambridge University Press, 2003.

1 Main Idea

2 General Notes

- Democracy is a redistributive activity and therefore stands to prevail when the impacts of this redistribution can be mitigated. Two pathways through which this can occur:
 1. Economic equality: there is little change to be expected from “fair” redistribution, so establishing a redistributive institution is unlikely to be particularly disruptive
 2. Capital mobility: the friction to redistribution is low/lessened such that the redistribution can occur without broad societal upheaval
- If capital is significantly mobile such that it could be redirected abroad in the face of threats/abuse, then the democratic state ultimately becomes limited in how much it can tax capital. This avoids conflict/tension and therefore supports peaceful democracy
- Claims that a demobilized lower class is critical for the peaceful sustenance of authoritarianism
- Primary operationalization of capital immobility is land: land cannot be hidden nor moved. Economic modernization involves a shift from immobility (land, natural resources) to mobility (human capital, other mobile capital)

3 Important Specific Factual Claims

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4 Connections

- Agrees and expands on Moore

5 My Critiques

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